

designers often use white space to make HTML more attractive to view, but it is unnecessary for the page to function properly. You can remove empty tags, redundant font and nested tags, unused and empty style definitions and even certain tags that you specify.

XML integration: You can use Extensible Markup Language (XML) to complement, rather than replace, your use of HTML. You can view or edit files, apply standard formatting to the structure of code in XML files, view the XML tree and create custom displays of XML data on Web pages. For example, you can use FrontPage to create a Web page that displays data from an XML file, format that data, and apply filtering, sorting, and conditional formatting to display the data the way you want.

Macromedia Flash support: To enhance and update your FrontPage Web site, you can add Macromedia Flash content such as short movie strips, repetitive audio-enhanced animations, previously recorded educational presentations or courses and more. You can set options for automatic playback such as playing a short animation once when the site visitor first loads the page or looping the content to play continuously.

Behaviors: Behaviors are scripting options that enable you to quickly add interactivity or increased functionality to text or other elements of your Web page. For example, you can specify that a sound file must play as a result of a site visitor clicking a graphic on a Web page. You can also view and edit the scripts associated with the current page by viewing a list in the Behaviors task pane.

Dynamic Web templates: You can save an HTML file as a dynamic Web template (*.dwt) that you can use to create and attach other HTML pages that share the same layout. You can protect your layout by specifying regions within the template as editable and non-editable. This means that you can allow other users to add and edit content but not change the layout of the master page template. Each time you update a dynamic Web template, all pages that are based on that template update as well.

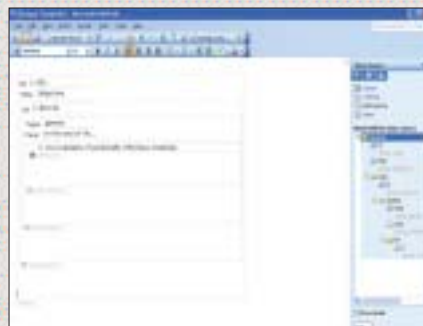
Layout tables: You can select from a list of pre-defined layouts and then apply

them to your Web pages. The layout tables are located in an easily accessible task pane. Therefore, when you are planning and designing your Web pages, you can quickly and easily try a variety of layouts before you make your final decision. **Image tracing:** Image Tracing is when you create a mock-up image of a Web page in a graphics program and then use it as a visual guide to create or trace the Web page design in FrontPage. You can show or hide the image, set its opacity, and change its position. You can view the tracing image in both the Design and Split views in FrontPage. Site visitors do not see the tracing image when viewing the site using a Web browser.

Layers: A layer is a container in a Web page that holds HTML page elements such as text and graphics. You can overlap, nest and show or hide layers on a page. You can also animate layers by using the Behaviors task pane, which enables you to add Dynamic HTML (DHTML) script to any tag within a Web page. In the Layers task pane, you can view an itemised list of all the layers within your Web page.

Other new additions

InfoPath: This application, named X docs in its beta stage, allows you to create templates and schemas; and the editor allows information to be entered and viewed. The idea is to provide you with a set of 25 templates based on industry-standard XML. That will enable develop-



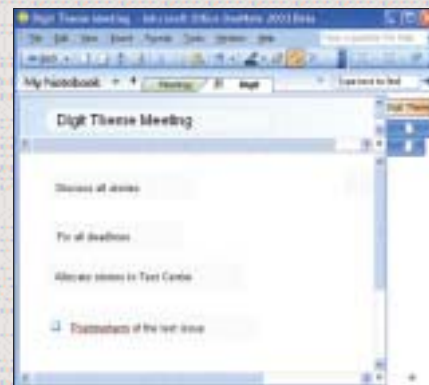
Creating templates and schemas using InfoPath

ers, third parties, corporate IT programmers and technical users to create additional templates, based on the XML schema they define, specific to their business or industry. Information will then be

entered onto these templates.

That allows customers to decide, through their own schema, what that data should look like. And because it's XML, we can then parse that data out of the document and send it to any XML-enabled back-end system from where it can also then be retrieved. It thus complements customers' existing infrastructures.

A better way to take notes: One Note allows for handwritten or typed notes, or both. Audio files, such as recorded conference calls, can also be inserted into



Improved note making

One Note, as can images captured from sources such as the Web or hand-made sketches with a stylus. One Note is aimed at a larger audience ranging from students doing research to business people managing notes taken down at meetings. One Note integrates, in some fashion, with Office applications. From One Note, for instance, you'll be able to e-mail your digital notes via Outlook.

Will it, won't it?

It is indeed good to see that Office applications will have support for XML. However, as seen above, Microsoft has improved FrontPage and Outlook a great deal but the rest of the applications in the Office suite have been given minimal improvements. Unlike the Office 2002 release, which had major improvements from 2000, we don't see significant improvements with this release. Since it is yet in its beta stage, we will have to wait and see what the final release has in store for the users.

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